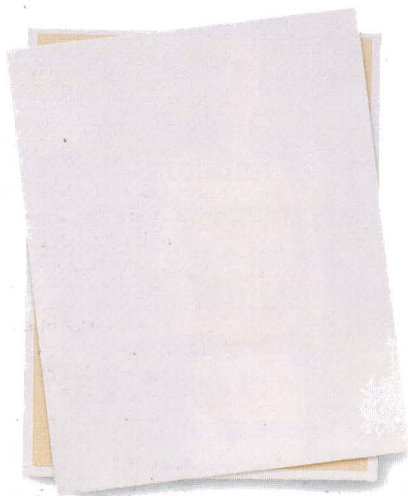


CHOOSING A SUPPORT

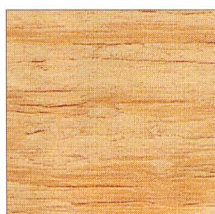
A SUPPORT IS THE SURFACE that you paint on, and the type of material you choose is ultimately a personal choice. You can paint either on a rigid support, such as a board or a panel, or on a flexible support such as canvas, but within that choice there are a range of different surface textures to pick from

that affect the way the paint behaves. Canvases and boards each have their own characteristic feel, and there is a big difference between the two. A hard, rigid support enables you to prepare a roughly textured surface for painting that would be quite impractical on a stretched canvas, but the flexibility and texture of canvas makes it a far more responsive surface on which to paint.

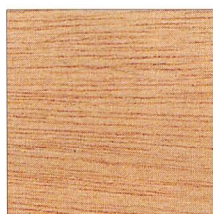


Canvas boards

These combine the rigidity of board and the texture of canvas. Although available from artists' suppliers, they are easily made by gluing linen to a piece of hardboard and then priming the entire surface.



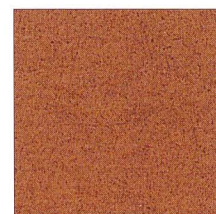
Blockboard



Plywood



Chipboard

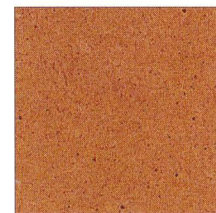


Hardboard

Types of panel and canvas

Rigid supports provide a sounder and more permanent basis for painting. The advantage of using a board is that you can alter its surface texture by "priming" it roughly or smoothly (see p.37). Wooden panels covered with linen are particularly durable. The most common materials for panels nowadays are fabricated boards such as plywood, hardboard, and fiberboard, rather than the traditional mahogany, poplar, and oak. Hardboard is a good choice, particularly for smaller panels. A recent development is honeycomb aluminum, which provides a strong support.

A traditional flexible support is linen canvas, and the flax fibers from which linen is woven are long and strong. Cotton fibers are not as strong, but some excellent cotton canvases are available in heavier weights. You should use at least a ten-ounce canvas cloth, and preferably a 12 ounce one. Weight is not so important when choosing a linen canvas. A new material, though not yet widely available, is the flexible, yet stable, polyester sailcloth.



Medium density fiberboard

Ready-primed canvas



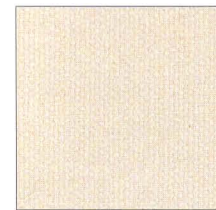
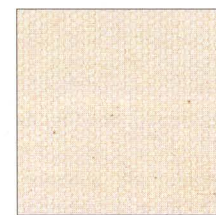
Coarse linen



Fine linen



Grained cotton

Cotton duck
12ozCotton duck
15oz